Milestone 1 | CIRES

Citizen Issue Reporting and Escalation System

What happens after a resident reports a community problem?

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A complaint can lose its trail

The approved proposal identified three possible gaps in how reports are handled.

Reporting	Residents may be unsure where to send an issue.
Ownership	An officer may receive a report without a clear assignment or deadline.
Follow-up	Residents may have no consistent way to check progress.
Discovery focus	One pilot area and two example categories: roads and drainage.

Five tests for the pilot

The proposal provides a starting hypothesis for local discovery.

Real	Look for a specific incident and the reporting route used.
Frequent	Check whether the same difficulty appears across accounts.
Painful	Record repeated visits, calls or delays when participants recall them.
Reachable	A resident, an assigned officer and a supervisor can describe the journey.
Buildable	One area and one escalation step keep the pilot manageable.

A blocked drain from report to follow-up

Illustrative walkthrough used to locate points where responsibility can become unclear.

01

Notice

Resident identifies a blocked drain.

›

02

Report

Resident contacts a local office.

›

03

Assign

Officer determines who will act.

›

04

Follow up

Resident checks for a decision.

Discovery question • Which step caused the longest gap, and what record was available?

Who reports, acts and oversees

The three roles form the proposed pilot. Their responsibilities still need local confirmation.

Resident

Submits the issue and checks its status.

Needs a reference and clear updates.

Assigned officer

Reviews the report, records action and updates its status.

Needs an assigned queue and deadline.

Supervisor

Reviews overdue cases and follows up with the officer.

Needs an escalation record.

Three conversations, three viewpoints

The team designed incident-based prompts. Individual interviews are not documented.

Resident	Walk me through your most recent report. Where did you start and what did you hear back?
Officer	Describe the last issue you received. How did you know it belonged to your office?
Supervisor	Recall an overdue issue. What first brought it to your attention?
Evidence recorded	Channel, handoffs, follow-up effort, available records and outcome.
Consent	Participation is voluntary. Notes use participant codes and omit unnecessary identifiers.

How each incident will be recorded

One record per incident, with role-specific follow-up prompts.

Interview record

01 Consent to take anonymised notes
02 Participant role and issue category
03 First report and first response
04 Next contact or transfer
05 Most difficult step and outcome

Follow-up probes

Resident • What showed your report had been received?

Officer • What information was missing when it reached you?

Supervisor • What record showed that action was overdue?

Where the trail could break

The group considered five risks in the example journey. These are hypotheses for interviews.

Routing	A report reaches an office that cannot handle it.
Acknowledgment	The resident receives no reference to use later.
Assignment	No one can identify the officer responsible for the next action.
Deadline	An overdue case becomes visible only after another complaint.
Closure	A case is marked resolved without an explanation of the action taken.

What residents may use today

These general reporting routes will be checked locally.

Office visit	Allows direct explanation. A receipt or later update depends on the process used.
Phone or message	Lets a resident reach a contact remotely. A shared tracking record may be unavailable.
Paper register	Can record receipt at an office. Follow-up may depend on staff retrieving the entry.

Residents need to see what happens next

The proposal identified a potential gap between reporting an issue and receiving a clear outcome.

Residents who report local road or drainage issues may struggle to tell whether their concern was received, assigned or acted on. If the reporting route provides no shared reference or status record, residents may need to contact the office again and supervisors may learn about delays late.

Evidence base • Approved topic proposal and illustrative process analysis. Local validation is pending.

One report, one accountable trail

The proposed pilot covers reporting, assignment, tracking, escalation and closure.

Submit	The resident receives a report reference.
Assign	The report goes to the pilot officer with a configurable deadline.
Track	The resident sees received, assigned, in progress or resolved.
Escalate	An overdue open report goes to the supervisor once, with a timestamp.
Close	The officer records the action taken and the case history remains available.

Resident interview

A blocked drain near a home • Fictional responses for design exploration

01 **Take me back to when you noticed the blockage. What did you do?**

I told the local office where the water was collecting and described the nearest landmark.

02 **How did you know whether your report had reached the right person?**

I had no reference. When I called again, I had to explain the location from the beginning.

03 **What update would have helped you decide whether to call again?**

A message showing who received the report and when I could expect another update.

Assigned officer interview

A drainage report reaches the office • Fictional responses for design exploration

01 **What would you check before accepting this report?**

I would check whether it falls within our area and whether the location is clear enough to find.

02 **Tell me about the handoff. What might the next officer need?**

The original description, the location, the deadline and a note about any action already taken.

03 **What would you record before closing it?**

The work completed and the date. The resident should be able to see a short explanation.

Supervisor interview

A report passes its deadline • Fictional responses for design exploration

01 **How would you first notice that action was overdue?**

I would check the open reports for any deadline that had passed without a resolution.

02 **What information would help you decide what to do next?**

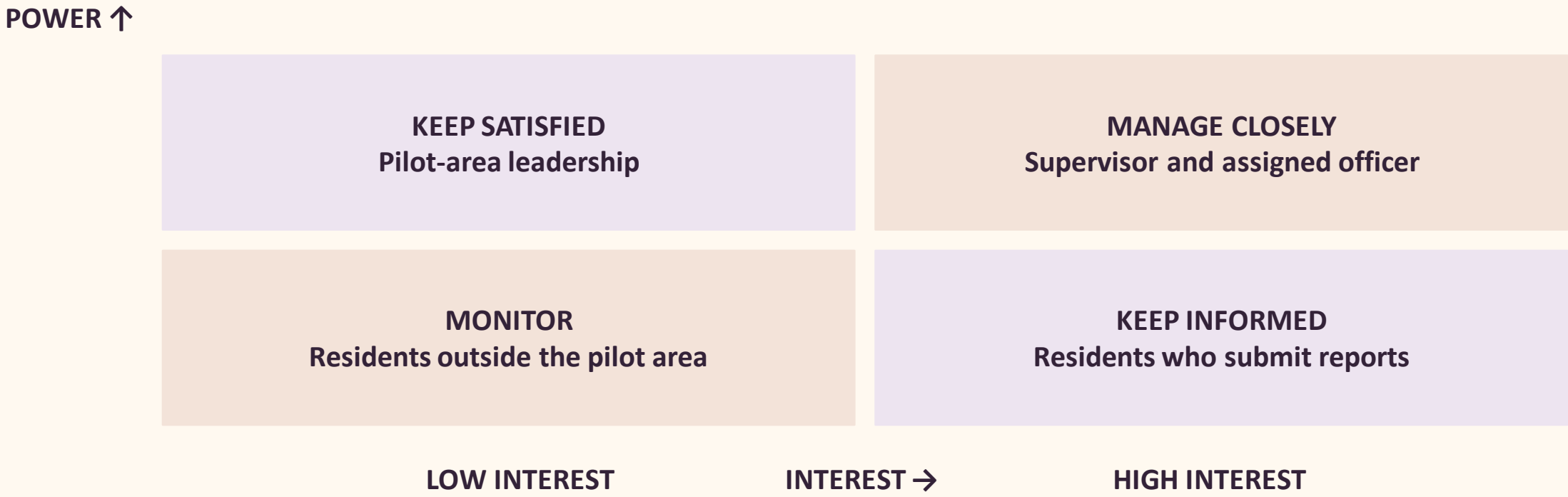
The assigned officer, the last action, the due time and how long the report has been overdue.

03 **What would make the escalation useful?**

One clear entry in my queue with a timestamp, so I can follow up without duplicate alerts.

Stakeholder power and interest

The positions reflect proposed pilot responsibilities.



Affinity map of reporting risks

The clusters organise issues raised by the fictional walkthroughs.



Brainstorming the report trail

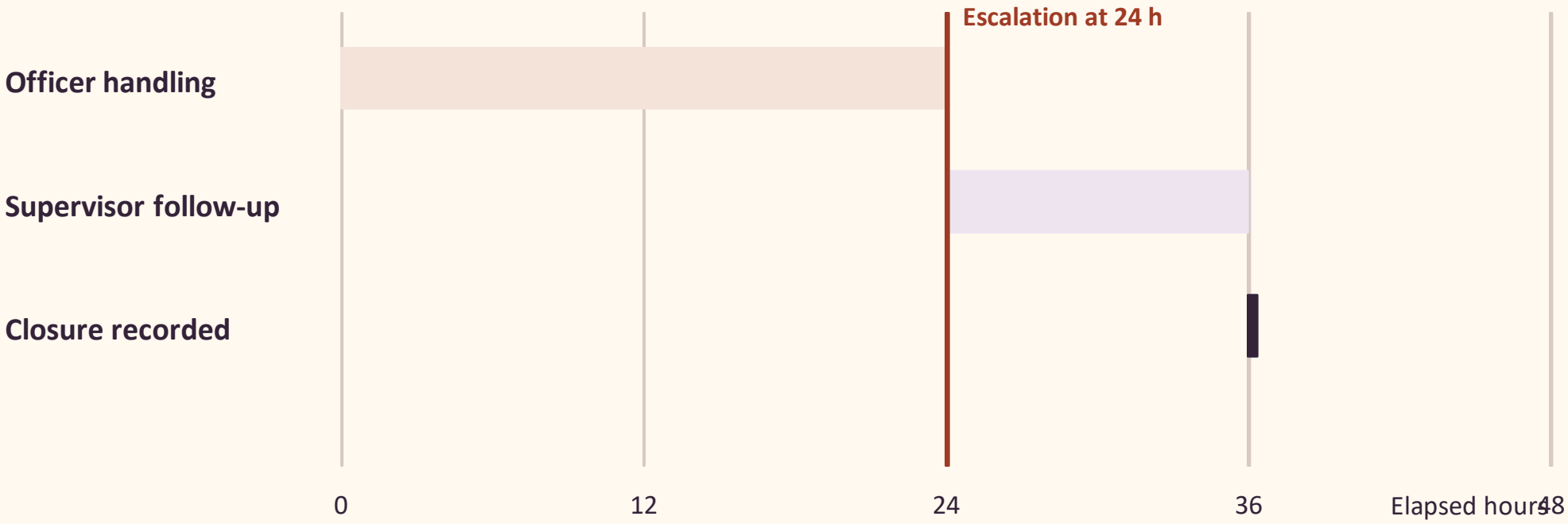
Each idea addresses a different point where follow-up can become difficult.



ILLUSTRATIVE TIMING CHART

When a report escalates

Example pilot timeline in hours after submission. Timing is illustrative and configurable.



At 24 h the case is still open, so CIRES routes it to the supervisor once. Closure follows recorded action at 36 h.

From discovery to requirements

Milestone 2 will turn the validated workflow into testable requirements.

Pilot scope

One area, roads and drainage, three roles and one escalation step.

Evidence for validation

Anonymised incident accounts and a comparison of local reporting routes.

Course basis • SECD Session Introductions, slides 16–26. Project basis • CIRES topic proposal.